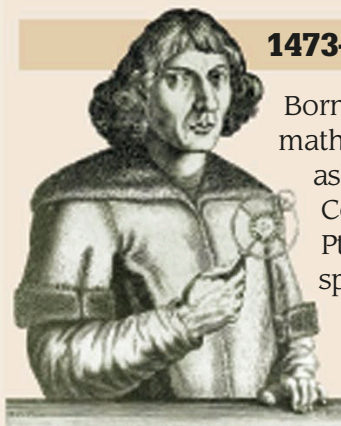




First surviving globe

The first surviving globe of the world was produced in 1492 by cartographer Martin Behaim, who made it for his home city of Nuremberg in Germany. It shows a world map and has many decorative illustrations.



1473–1543 NICOLAUS COPERNICUS

Born in Poland, Copernicus studied astronomy, mathematics, law, and medicine in Italy. When asked to take part in a reform of the calendar, Copernicus began to study Greek astronomer Ptolemy's 1,500-year-old system of celestial spheres, in which he found flaws.



Painting by Andreas Cellarius depicting Copernicus's Sun-centered Universe, 1660

The Copernican cosmos

Copernicus did not disagree with Ptolemy's idea that the planets rotated in concentric spheres, but he made corrections to some of Ptolemy's other notions. In his amended version, he placed the Sun at the center of the Universe, not Earth, as Ptolemy had done.

1505



1525

1527

Classifying chemicals

German chemist Theophrastus von Hohenheim (better known as Paracelsus) worked out a new classification for chemical substances.

This was based on a division of substances into salts, sulfurs, and mercuries, according to their properties.

1543

Illustrated anatomy

Flemish physician Andreas Vesalius published *De Humani Corporis Fabrica* (On the Structure of the Human Body), which remained a standard textbook for centuries. New printing techniques produced full-color plates illustrating human anatomy in the clearest detail seen so far.



Diagram of muscles from *De Humani Corporis Fabrica*

By 1500, printing presses had been set up in 282 cities and had printed around 28,000 editions of books.